Fangyi Li

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Education

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor — Ann Arbor, MI
Master of Science in Information (UX Research and Design) — *Expected May 2027*

Davidson College — Davidson, NC
Bachelor of Science in Psychology (Magna Cum Laude), Minor in Data Science — *May 2025*

Work Experience

User Experience Intern — June 2026 – August 2026
Beijing Xingyun Digital Technology Co., Ltd. (ZTE Corporation) — *Beijing, China*

- Conducted UX audits and heuristic evaluations of an internal AI chatbot used daily by 7,000 employees, synthesizing cross-functional user feedback to identify usability and interaction issues
- Delivered actionable UX recommendations that informed the launched redesign, improving interaction intuitiveness, visual consistency across interfaces, and feature discoverability and accessibility
- Supported cross-functional product and marketing initiatives, including AI-assisted project documentation and materials for international technology exhibitions in Shanghai and Barcelona

Project Experience

UX Researcher — February 2026 – Present
Nature Observer (AI-powered Plant Education App) — *Ann Arbor, MI*

- Led early-stage UX research for an AI-powered plant education app, identifying gaps in existing plant identification tools in supporting active learning and knowledge retention
- Conducted stakeholder and user interviews with botanical garden staff, casual visitors, and plant enthusiasts to understand learning behaviors and unmet needs
- Synthesized research findings to define target users and key opportunity areas, informing product direction and feature design
- Designed high-fidelity prototypes based on research insights to support intuitive, learning-centered user experiences

UX Researcher — January 2026 – May 2026
Vizard.ai (AI Video Editing Platform) — *Ann Arbor, MI*

- Led end-to-end UX research for an AI-assisted video editing platform, identifying friction in short-form content creation related to clip selection, editing control, and trust in AI-generated outputs
- Conducted user and stakeholder interview to understand creator workflows, needs, and pain points
- Mapped user workflows and performed comparative analysis and heuristic evaluation to identify usability gaps and opportunities for differentiation
- Synthesized findings into actionable insights to inform more intuitive and transparent editing experiences for content creators

UX Researcher — January 2026 – February 2026
Civic User Testing Group (CUTGroup), UMSI — *Ann Arbor, MI*

- Led usability testing with 12 participants on Michigan's Small Claims Form, identifying critical comprehension and workflow barriers for non-legal users in high-stakes legal scenarios

- Conducted semi-structured interviews to evaluate user understanding and navigation of legal forms
- Synthesized qualitative data using affinity diagramming to uncover misalignment between user mental models and form design
- Presented actionable recommendations to civic stakeholders and city staff to improve accessibility and usability in future form redesign

Skills

Research: User interviews, Usability testing, Survey design, Heuristic evaluation, A/B testing, Accessibility evaluation, Qualitative research, Mixed-methods research, Stakeholder interviews
Analysis: Research synthesis, Affinity diagramming, Thematic analysis, Statistical analysis, Experimental design, Data visualization
Tools: Survey & Data: Qualtrics, R (Shiny, Tidyverse), Tableau; Prototype: Figma, Miro; Programming: Python, SQL, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, React; Collaboration: Google Workspace, Microsoft Office